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Home Safety Checklist for Older Adults

A room-by-room guide to preventing falls at home

Print this checklist and walk through your loved one's home together. Check off each item that's already in place, and make note of what needs to be addressed. A safer home starts with a single walk-through.

Use the checkboxes to mark completed items. Items left unchecked are your action list.

ALL ROOMS & HALLWAYS

- Pathways are clear of clutter, boxes, and loose items
- Loose rugs and mats have been removed or secured with non-slip backing
- Electrical and phone cords are moved out of walking paths
- Lighting is adequate — especially in hallways and stairways
- Light switches are accessible at both ends of every hallway and stairway
- Nightlights are installed in hallways, bedroom, and bathroom

BEDROOM

- Nightlight or motion-activated light is on the path to the bathroom
- A lamp or light switch is reachable from the bed without getting up
- Phone is reachable from the bed in case of emergency
- Bed height allows feet to rest flat on the floor when sitting on edge
- No loose rugs between bed and bathroom
- Frequently used items are within easy reach — no stepping on chairs

BATHROOM

- Grab bar installed beside the toilet (not a towel bar)
- Grab bar installed inside the shower or tub
- Non-slip mat inside the shower or tub
- Non-slip bath rug on the floor outside the shower or tub
- Shower chair or bench available if needed
- Hot water heater set to 120 degrees F or below to prevent scalding
- Toiletries stored at easy reach — no bending or stretching required

KITCHEN

- Frequently used items stored between hip and shoulder height
- Non-slip mat in front of the sink
- Step stool with a handle used instead of a chair for reaching
- Spills cleaned up immediately
- Good lighting over countertops and work areas

STAIRS & ENTRYWAYS

- Sturdy handrail on both sides of all staircases
- Handrails extend the full length of the staircase
- All steps are even in height — no broken or uneven steps
- Outdoor steps have non-slip treads
- Entryway is well lit, including porch and path to door
- Doorbell and door handle accessible without stepping over a threshold

GENERAL SAFETY

- Emergency phone numbers posted visibly near the phone
- Personal emergency response system (medical alert button) worn consistently
- Medications stored in a consistent, organized location
- Walking aid (cane or walker) is nearby and being used consistently
- Shoes with non-slip soles worn inside the home — no bare feet or socks only

NEXT STEPS

After completing this checklist, share your findings with your loved one's physical or occupational therapist. They can help prioritize which changes will have the most impact and provide guidance on installing equipment correctly.

***Savoy Therapy provides complimentary fall prevention screenings and home safety guidance.
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